Facets - GraphQL API

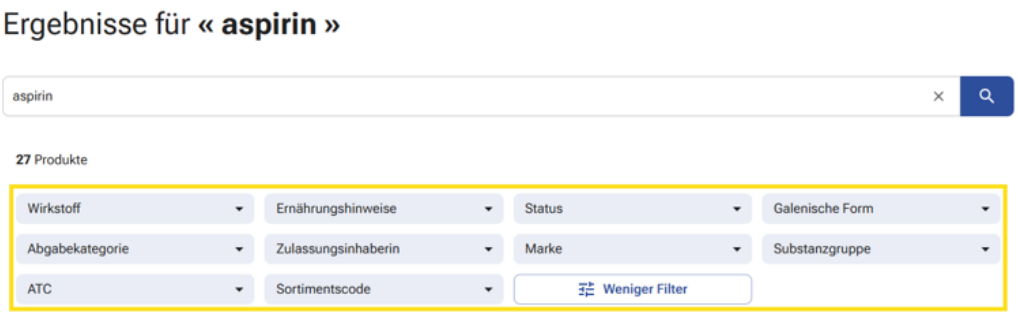
What Are Facets?

Facets are **dynamic filter options** that are generated based on your current search results. Think of them like the filters you see on an online shop. For example, to filter products by *Active Substance*, *Galenic Form*, or *Dispensing Category*.

Facets are organized into **Facet Groups**. Each group represents a category (e.g., "Active Substance"), and contains individual **Facet Values** (e.g., "Paracetamol", "Ibuprofen") along with an **identifier** and a **count** showing how many products match that value.

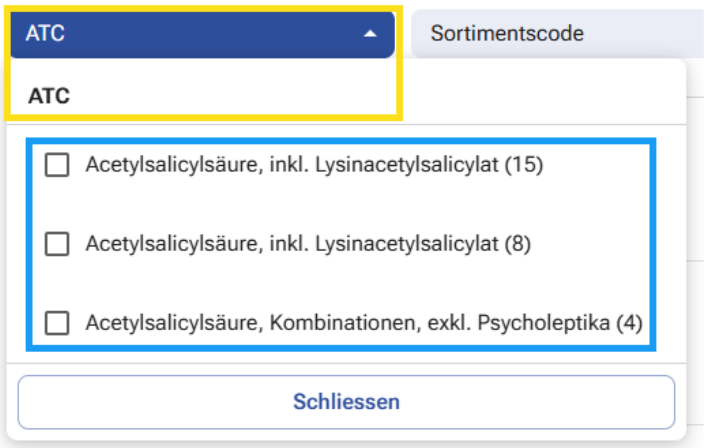
How are they shown in our user interface?

In our user interface, Facet Groups (yellow) are shown as filters:



Facet Groups

When opening a Facet Group (yellow), the Facets (blue) are shown with their description and count.



ATC Facet Group with its Facets

How Facets Work – Step by Step

The process follows a **two-step pattern**: first *retrieve* facets, then *apply* them.

Step 1 – Search Products and Retrieve Facets

When a user searches for products or simply applies a filter, the API returns:

- A **list of matching products** (with pagination).
- The **available facet groups and their values**, calculated from the returned results.

Customizing the Returned Facet Groups

You can tailor which facet groups are returned and how they are presented:

Option	What it does	Available values
Filter by group type	Include or exclude specific facet groups	• Include: Use `in` to specify one or more facet groups, to be included. This is useful, if you want to explicitly configure the facet groups to be used. • Exclude: Use `nIn` (not in) to exclude certain group types. This is useful, if you want facet groups, added to the API, to be automatically used, but want to exclude some known ones.
Sort groups	Control the order of facet groups	`Rank` (predefined priority order, default) or `Alphabetic` In the future, a sort by usage will be offered.

Customizing the Facets Within Each Group

Each facet group contains individual facet values. These can also be customized:

Option	What it does	Default	**Range**
Sort	Order facet values by `Count` or `Alphabetic`	`Count`	-

Limit	Maximum number of facet values to return	10	1-1000
Min Count	Only show values with at least this many matching products	1	1-1000

Step 2 – Apply Facets to Narrow Results

Once a user selects one or more facet values (e.g., *Active Substance = "Paracetamol"*), the application sends a **new search request** that includes the selected facets as filters.

The selected facets are passed alongside any other filters. Both the filter and the facets are combined with an **AND** logic — meaning all conditions must be met.

> **Example:** A user searches for "headache", then selects *Active Substance: Paracetamol* and *Galenic Form: Tablet*. The API returns only products matching "headache" that contain Paracetamol **and** come in tablet form.

Summary

Concept	Explanation
Facet Group	A category of filter options (e.g., "Active Substance")
Facet Value	A specific option within a group (e.g., "Paracetamol") with a count
Retrieving Facets	Facets are returned automatically as part of a product search
Applying Facets	Selected facet values are sent back as filters in a follow-up search
Counts	Each facet value shows how many products match, helping users make informed choices